

Background & Industry Overview

1

- Digital transformation is changing what leadership means in IT
- Leaders now need more than technical skill — confidence, ethics, sustainability

3

- Indian IT sector: grown from a small software base to a global tech hub
- Major firms (TCS, Infosys, Wipro, Cognizant, Accenture) heavily investing in AI and cloud

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Theoretical Background

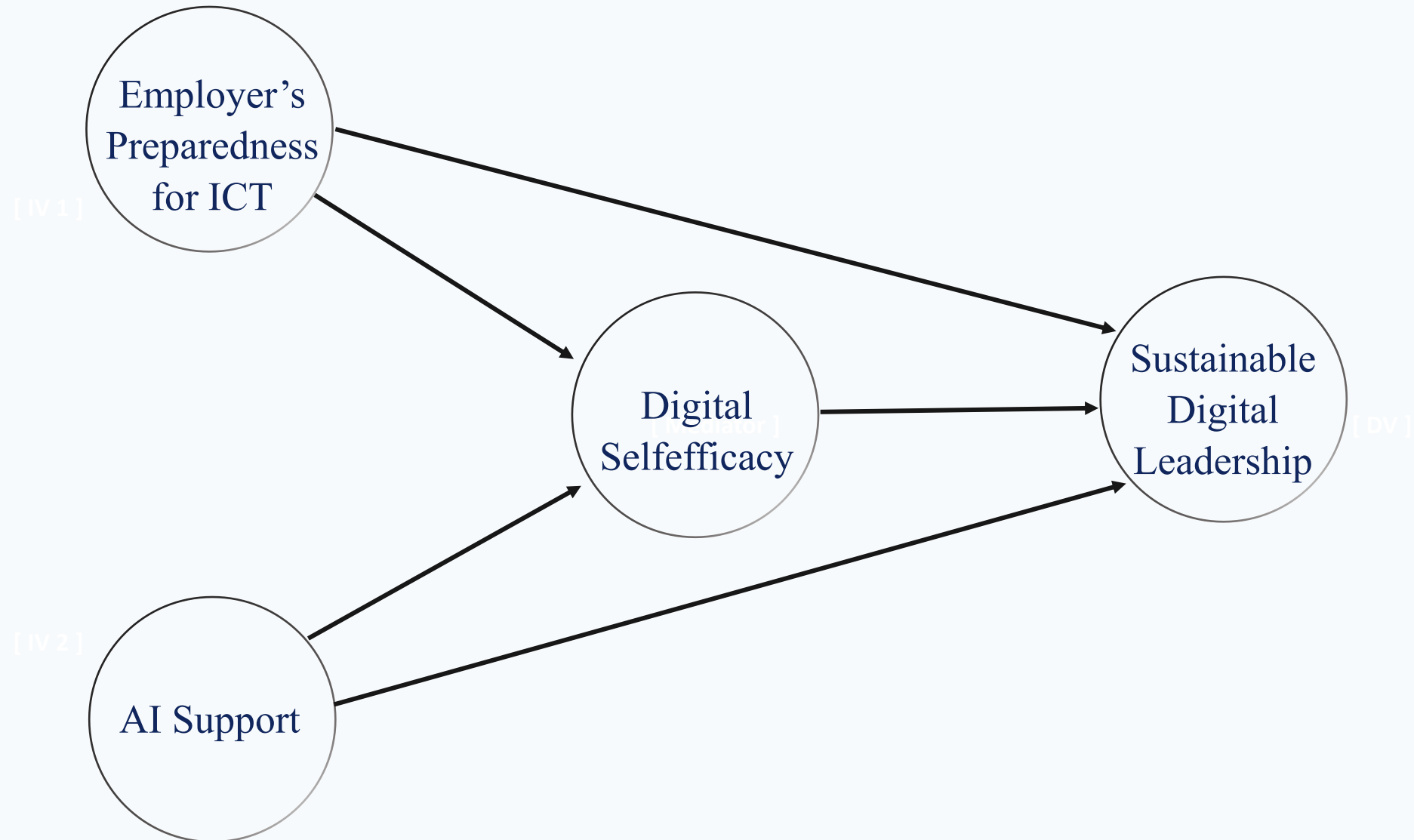
- Grounded in Bandura's Social Cognitive Theory (Self Efficacy)
- Self efficacy = belief in one's own ability to perform a task
- Shaped by experience, encouragement, and exposure
- Application: organizational support builds employee confidence
- That confidence, in turn, drives sustainable leadership behavior

Literature Review & Research Gap

- *Digital leadership was initially studied as a narrow, industry-specific skill, such as its link to innovation in telecom firms (Wasono & Furinto, 2018)*
- *Later research repositioned it as a broader capability, shaped by digital transformation and firm performance outcomes (Senadjki et al., 2026)*
- *More recent studies show digital leadership working through organizational culture and employee digital capability, not individual behavior alone (Shin et al., 2027)*
- *Digital Self-Efficacy has evolved from a general confidence measure into a distinct, validated construct shaping digital behavior at work (Ulfert-Blank & Schmidt, 2022)*

- *No study combines ICT, AI Support, and DSE in one model*
- *Very limited empirical evidence specific to Indian IT sector*

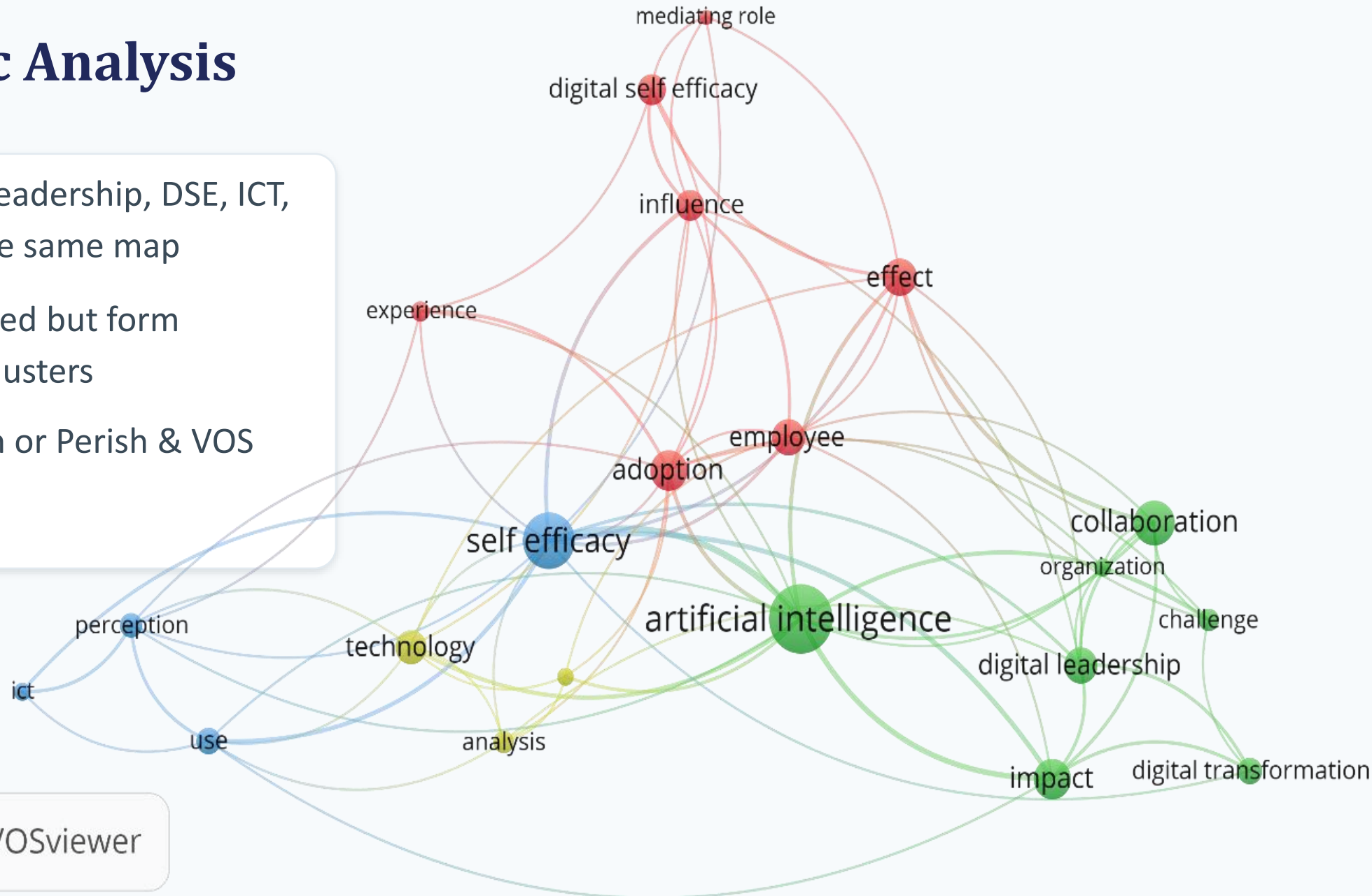
Conceptual Framework



Bibliometric Analysis

- Key terms (Digital Leadership, DSE, ICT, AI) appear within the same map
- Constructs are related but form separate thematic clusters

Software used: Publish or Perish & VOS Viewer



VOSviewer

Factor Analysis & Cluster Table

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**VOSviewer output
processed in Excel and SPSS
Rotated Component Matrix
used to group related terms
Formed 9 clusters of
research themes**

Cluster 1	ICT, Perception, Use
Cluster 2	Digital self efficacy, Effect, Influence, Mediating role
Cluster 3	Analysis, Human Resource Management, Technology
Cluster 4	Adoption, Experience
Cluster 5	Collaboration, Digital Leadership, Digital transformation
Cluster 6	Self efficacy
Cluster 7	Artificial Intelligence, Challenge, Organisation,
Cluster 8	Impact
Cluster 9	Employee

Design & Sample



384

(Cochran's Formula)

SAMPLE SIZE

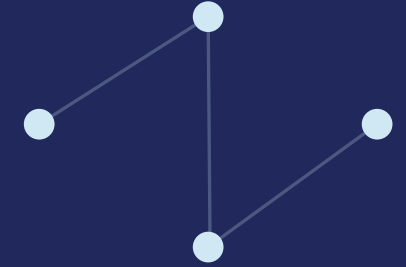
Smart PLSSEM

ANALYTICAL TOOL

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- Quantitative, crosssectional survey design
 - Questionnaire built from validated Scopusindexed scales
 - Distributed and collected online
 - 5point Likert scale
 - Demographics: age, gender, experience, designation
 - Sampling: stratified random, across firms and roles

Hypotheses

- - H1** Employer's Preparedness for ICT positively influences Sustainable Digital Leadership.
 - H2** AI Support positively influences Sustainable Digital Leadership
 - H3** Employer's Preparedness for ICT positively influences Digital Self-Efficacy.
 - H4** AI Support positively influences Digital Self-Efficacy.
 - H5** Digital Self-Efficacy positively influences Sustainable Digital Leadership.
 - H6** Digital Self-Efficacy mediates the relationship between Employer's Preparedness for ICT and Sustainable Digital Leadership.
 - H7** Digital Self-Efficacy mediates the relationship between AI Support and Sustainable Digital Leadership.



Limitations

Does not represent full industry diversity

Self-reported data may introduce bias

Cros-ssectional design — single point in time, not longitudinal

Findings may not generalize beyond large Indian IT firms



Demographic Analysis

- Majority aged 20–30 years
- Mostly 1–3 years of work experience
- Largest group from Software Development/Engineering
- Sample skews toward early-career professionals

Measurement Model Results



Construct Reliability & Validity

Outer loadings tested - weak items removed; retained items exceeds threshold [0.70]

Reliability - Composite Reliability threshold met [0.7 and above]

Convergent validity - AVE threshold met [0.50 and above]



Discriminant validity

HTMT ratios all below 0.90 — constructs are distinct

Fornell-Larcker criterion satisfied — each construct's AVE root exceeds inter-construct correlations

Cross-loadings confirm items align with intended constructs

Structural Model Results

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$$R^2 = 0.609$$

*Variance explained in
Sustainable Digital Leadership*

$$\text{Outer VIF} < 5.0$$

No collinearity among indicators

$$\text{Inner VIF} < 5.0$$

*No collinearity among predictor
constructs*

Path Coefficients & Hypothesis Testing

Path	O	T-stat	Pvalue	Result
ICT > DSE	0.519	12.690	0.000	Supported
ICT > SDL	0.105	2.192	0.028	Supported
AIS > DSE	0.259	5.341	0.000	Supported
AIS > SDL	0.512	13.568	0.000	Supported
DSE > SDL	0.285	6.363	0.000	Supported
ICT > DSE > SDL	0.148	5.333	0.000	Supported
AIS > DSE > SDL	0.074	4.486	0.000	Supported

Findings

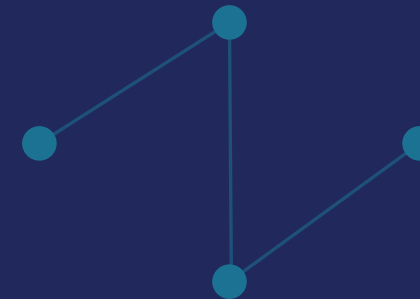
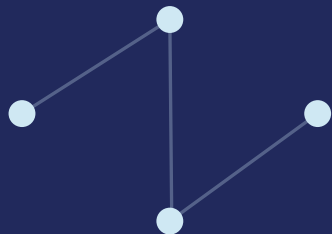
- ICT support, built employee confidence more than it directly shaped leadership behavior
- Working with AI showed a stronger link to leadership than ICT infrastructure did
- Employee confidence showed the strongest link to leadership behavior among all factors tested
- These results support the mediation model proposed in this study

Conclusion



- Sustainable digital leadership is built through both technology investment and employee confidence
- AI Support is emerging as central to leadership development in Indian IT
- Digital Self-Efficacy is the bridge between organizational conditions and leadership outcomes
- Confirms the study's mediation model across all tested relationships

Thank You



Key Constructs

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IV 1

[Construct name]

[short definition]

IV 2

[Construct name]

[short definition]

MEDIATOR

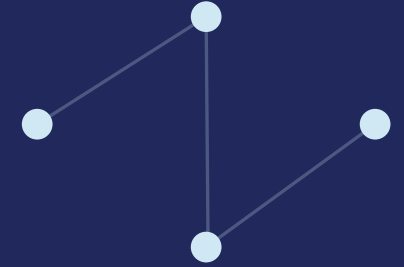
[Construct name]

[short definition]

DV

[Construct name]

[short definition]



03

Results

[Measurement model and structural model findings]



Mediating Role of [Mediator]

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PATH 1

[IV1 → Mediator → DV]

$\beta = [.___]$

PATH 2

[IV2 → Mediator → DV]

$\beta = [.___]$

[Note whether indirect effects are stronger than direct effects, and what this implies]

What We'll Cover

1

Background & Research Gap

2

Key Constructs & Theory

3

Objectives & Hypotheses

4

Conceptual Framework

5

Research Design & Sample

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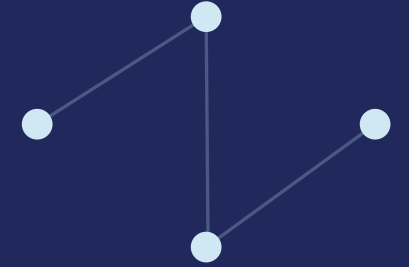
Measurement Model Results

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Structural Model Results

8

Conclusion & Implications



01

Background

[Sector context and the shifting demands on digital leadership]



Measurement Instrument



Construct	Items	Source
[Construct 1]	[#]	[Author, Year]
[Construct 2]	[#]	[Author, Year]
[Construct 3]	[#]	[Author, Year]
[Construct 4]	[#]	[Author, Year]

- [Scale type — e.g., 5point Likert]
- [Analytical software / technique used]